



The Humanitas Institute

## Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Classical School of Wichita  
School Website: <https://cswsaints.com/>

December 21, 2025

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**Disclaimer**

*This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.*

**ACCS Member School**

*Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.*

## Executive Summary

Classical School of Wichita (CSW) is strongly aligned with classical education as defined by the Six Essential Elements. Public-facing CSW materials repeatedly emphasize the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Great Books/Great Conversation through Omnibus history and literature, a Christ-centered formation, reverence for Truth-Goodness-Beauty, and a family-centered, prayerful, liturgical rhythm in learning. The school presents a coherent classical formation across curriculum, pedagogy, faculty role, and parent partnership, and it maintains explicit references to virtue, character formation, and a "living curriculum" through its faculty and community ethos. Evidence from CSW's site materials shows explicit integration of theology, biblical foundations, liturgical practice (hymn singing, liturgical rhythm), a K-12 Trivium-based progression, Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin, and conscious formation of a Portrait of a Graduate guided by Christian virtue. The school also foregrounds parental partnership as a core principle, aligning with the classical model of formation that involves families as co-educators.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

- Most evident strengths: explicit Trivium framework, Great Books/Great Conversation, integrated liberal arts approach (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Latin), and a clearly stated teleology focused on virtue, wisdom, and God-centered formation. The public materials consistently foreground Truth-Goodness-Beauty, theological framing, baptismal/catechetical vocabulary, and a communal liturgical rhythm. These features map strongly to the Positive Keyword indicators in the classical lexicon and to the Six Essential Elements' recommended practices.
- Notable alignment features: (a) curricular structure around the Trivium and Great Books; (b) emphasis on formation, virtue, and wisdom over mere career-focused outcomes; (c) ongoing parent partnership; (d) a "living curriculum" concept via faculty modeling virtue and humanities mastery.

Citations anchor points for the above general assessment include CSW mission and faith language, Trivium emphasis, Great Books/Great Conversation references, and explicit parent partnership.

- Mission/Foundations: Truth-Goodness-Beauty; in Christ; biblical/theological framing.
- Curriculum and Great Books: Omnibus/Great Conversation; grammar-logic-rhetoric progression; Latin; history across curricula with focus on classical civilizations.
- Pedagogy: lower-school singing/memorization with a contemplative (Scholé) thread; upper-school Socratic discussion and rhetoric-focused work (thesis, defense).
- Faculty: living curriculum and faculty-as-mentors; explicit emphasis on virtue and modeling.
- Parents & Community: formalized parent partnership and co-teaching stance; opportunities for parental formation and open campus visits.

Key CSW-cited sources illustrating these features include mission statements, Trivium pedagogy, Great Books/Omnibus references, Fine Arts and liturgical elements, and explicit teacher-student/family partnerships. See evidence snippets from CSW public materials and CSW's public-facing handbooks and pages.

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## Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

### Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission statements and faith-centered framing explicitly foreground Truth, Goodness, and Beauty and Christ-centered formation. Texts describe education as formation in a Christian context, with integration of theology and biblical instruction throughout the program.

- Communal liturgical practices and worship language, and statements about The Bible, Gospels, and a theologically grounded worldview appear in multiple CSW materials (e.g., “Distinctively Christian,” Statement of Faith elements in governance/public materials).
- The Great Conversation and theological framing are connected to the Trivium and classical formation (grammar/logic/rhetoric) with historical/theological anchors.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; Jesus Christ, gospel, Bible/scripture; theology; liturgy; worship; reverence; wonder; imago Dei; logos; virtue; wisdom; virtue formation; sacred music; chant. These map to the core Positive Keyword set for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. - Negative indicators: virtually none evident in public CSW materials (no explicit relativism or secular-humanist framing observed).

Why this rating - The school explicitly treats education as formation in a Christian-theological frame and integrates theology into curricular and communal life. The presence of liturgical/classical practices and a theology-grounded mission aligns strongly with a CLASSICAL orientation for this category.

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### Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school's mission centers on cultivation of wisdom and virtue, not merely job preparation; formation of character and human excellence is foregrounded. The mission states nourishing hearts and minds on Truth, Goodness, and Beauty so that in Christ they can glorify God. - Reference to permanence of truth and beauty and the teleology of forming virtuous and wise human beings; emphasis on formation over information. - The public materials consistently frame education as “formation” and the cultivation of virtue (e.g., Portrait of a Graduate, habit formation, and moral imagination) within a classical-Christian frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, beauty, the true/good/beautiful; liberal education/telos; scholé/ contemplation; Great Books/Great Conversation as a humanistic telos. - Negative keywords observed: none (no explicit “career-readiness” or job-prep framing). The materials emphasize formation over workforce preparation.

Why this rating - The CSW materials demonstrate a consistent aim toward virtue, wisdom, and humane excellence rather than vocational metrics, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for purpose and goal.

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### Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Core curricular framework explicitly centers on the Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and the Trivium, with a Quadrivium extension (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) as foundational elements. The school presents Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric stages (K-12) and discusses their roles within Omnibus Ancient/Medieval history and literature, i.e., the Great Conversation. - History is studied throughout the curriculum through Omnibus (Ancient/Medieval History and Literature), not labeled as “Social Studies.” This is explicit in the Trivium/GREAT BOOKS framing. - Great Books/Great Conversation is embedded through Omnibus and public-facing statements about the Great Conversation. Latin, logic, rhetoric, and classical literary study appear across stages. - Education aims to cultivate wonder; the lower grades emphasize memory, recitation, and devotional/wonderful experiences, while upper grades emphasize rhetoric and thesis work.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium), Great Books/Great Conversation, Omnibus, Latin, history as a canonical discipline,

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memory/recitation, wonder, and integration of arts and sciences. - Negative keywords observed: minimal to none; there is no explicit emphasis on project-based-only or purely experiential learning displacing liberal arts or Great Books, which would be a negative signal per the Six Elements lexicon.

Why this rating - The curriculum language and structure align squarely with classical pedagogy and content: Trivium, Great Books, and the integrated liberal arts. The public materials emphasize a Great Conversation through Omnibus and explicit classical progression, fulfilling Element 3 criteria.

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#### **Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Lower-grade pedagogy includes singing, memorization, and restfulness in learning (recitation, scholé-like elements). Upper grades emphasize Socratic discussion, seminars, and debates, with students producing theses and defending arguments (senior thesis). The school explicitly connects the Trivium to pedagogy (Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric). - The Great Conversation is framed as a central pedagogical and curricular device; upper-level rhetoric and thesis work align with classical rhetorical training. - The division of stages (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) and the emphasis on memory, recitation, and structured discussion reflect a balanced pedagogy that supports both contemplative (Scholé) and rigorous discourse (Socratic/seminar-style).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: scholé/restful learning, recitation/memorization/chanting; singing; memory-based learning; Socratic discussion/seminars; rhetoric training; public speaking; senior thesis; defended theses; learning through dialogue. - Negative keywords observed: limited presence of purely project-based or constructivist approaches; the site emphasizes classical forms of pedagogy rather than primarily project-based or student-directed paradigms. This maps to a lack of the modern “project-based learning” emphasis in public materials (which would be a negative signal in this rubric).

Why this rating - Pedagogy aligns with classical expectations: restfulness in parts (Scholé), memorization and chant in lower grades, Socratic discourse and rhetoric at higher levels, and a thesis-based culminative capstone in high school. This combination supports CLASSICAL status in pedagogy.

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#### **Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Faculty are described as models for students, mentors, and living exemplars; there is emphasis on virtue, skill, and knowledge in teacher role, with Luke 6:40 as a guiding verse. The faculty are presented as the “living curriculum” and as colleagues who share in the classical mission. - Portraits of faculty and staff are used to communicate the expected character and professional standards; teachers are expected to be committed to Christ, excellent teachers, and lovers of learning. - Public materials emphasize a collegial, virtuous, mentor-like faculty culture, aligned with classical education expectations of the teacher as master-mentor.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; portrait of a faculty/staff member; mentor; virtuous exemplars; master-teacher model; collegial culture; teachers as mentors; Christ-centered professionalism. - Negative keywords observed: none that signal a departure from classical faculty norms.

Why this rating - The faculty framing emphasizes virtue, lifelong learning, and mentorship, aligning with CLASSICAL expectations for the faculty category.

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#### **Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Parent Partnership materials state that CSW does not function above parental authority but partners with parents in education; parents have delegated responsibility and are co-educators, with opportunities for involvement and formation. This is a core classical-education dynamic. - The school indicates it

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educates parents through the website, book studies, and gatherings so they can learn more about classical education; there are open invitations for visits and involvement. - The plan for parent engagement includes explicit parental formation and a family-centered approach; the community is described as activated through parent participation and shared mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents; co-teachers; parental formation; book studies; parent involvement; open campus, visits; family-centered education. - Negative keywords observed: none; no consumerist/low-engagement cues; the content emphasizes active partnership.

Why this rating - The CSW materials firmly place parents as co-educators and emphasize ongoing parental formation and involvement in classical education, fulfilling Element 6's criteria.

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### **What Would Move the Needle**

- Not applicable in this instance since all six categories are CLASSICAL. If any category were classified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, this section would propose concrete steps (e.g., explicitly increasing liturgical/community practices, expanding Great Books exposure, or expanding teacher development in classical pedagogy). In CSW's case, the overlap across evidence suggests alignment with classical aims; no major needle-moving changes are required.
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# Appendix

## ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

### Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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